

Speaker Sessions and Bios

Parenting in the Heat of the Moment by Dr. Philip Mamalakis

It is hard to think straight, let alone respond properly, in the heat of the parenting moment, when our kids misbehave, don't listen to our words, or talk back. In this talk, Dr. Mamalakis will provide 4 steps for those moments we feel stuck, overwhelmed, or about to explode, that will guide our children Toward the Kingdom.

Dr. Philip Mamalakis, with his wife, Georgia, has seven children and three grandchildren and lives in Boston, Massachusetts. He is the Associate Professor of Pastoral Care at Holy Cross Greek Orthodox School of Theology. He is the author of *Parenting Toward the Kingdom*, (AFP, 2016) as well as, *The Companion Guide to Parenting Toward the Kingdom* (AFP, 2024) for parents to gather together for support and guidance.

“The Darkness Comprehended It Not”: Orthodox Christian Evangelism and Future in America by Fr. Andrew Stephen Damick

What does it mean to do Orthodox Christian evangelism in America now? How can it be done well? And what does the Orthodox future look like in America?

Fr. Andrew Stephen Damick is the Chief Content Officer of Ancient Faith Ministries and an archpriest of the Antiochian Orthodox Christian Archdiocese of North America. He is the host or co-host of numerous Ancient Faith Radio podcasts and author of several books.

Renewing Our Faith by Fr. Nicholas Louh

“Renewing Our Faith” acts as a spiritual reset, inviting you to trade the frantic “noise” of modern life for the restorative stillness of hesychia. By stepping away from digital distractions and daily anxieties, we create a sacred space where Christ becomes the focal point once more.

Rev. Dr. Nicholas Louh is the Senior Priest of St. John the Divine Greek Orthodox Church in Jacksonville, FL. Alongside his wife, Dr. Roxanne, he co-hosts a weekly podcast, Live with the Loughs on Ancient Faith Radio. They co-authored *Renewing You: A Priest, A Psychologist, and a Plan* and *6 Hours, 7 Lessons: How Christ's Light Transcends Our Darkness*. Fr. Nicholas lives in Jacksonville with his wife, Dr. Roxanne, and their two children, George and Gabriella.

Sacramental Life in a Secular Age by Dr. Zachary Porcu

How do we understand the sacramental life? This question is vital because modern people, even pious ones, unconsciously believe all sorts of assumptions about the world that are ultimately secular. But the way that we really understand religion, God, the liturgy, and

morality starts with realizing that the physical and the spiritual are fundamentally inseparable.

Dr. Zac Porcu earned his PhD in Church history at the Catholic University of America and holds additional degrees in Philosophy, Classics, and Interdisciplinary Humanities. He has taught history, philosophy, and theology at private schools and universities on both the East and West coasts and is a catechist at St. Andrew's Orthodox Church in Riverside. He hosts the Roots of Everything podcast and is the author of *Journey to Reality: Sacramental Life in a Secular Age*.